START HERE

From the folder to the pulpit

Sermon Kit 3: Belshazzar — "The Weightless King"

THE SHORT VERSION

Read the manuscript once. **Make it yours** in the DOCX. **Rehearse** it aloud with the outline. **Preach** it. The slides and guide support the sermon; they are not the sermon.

WHAT'S IN THE FOLDER

- **00 · Start Here** — this sheet.
- **01 · Preaching Manuscript** — 6,840 words in two formats. PDF to read; DOCX to edit.
- **02 · One-Page Outline** — movements, timings, lines to land, and the 50-minute cut.
- **03 · Small-Group Guide** — eight questions and leader notes for a follow-up group.
- **04 · Slides (PPTX)** — twelve 16:9 slides, editable in PowerPoint, Keynote, or Google Slides.
- **05 · Slides (PNG)** — the same twelve slides as images for a projector or video.
- **06 · Preaching License** — one page. Keep it with your order records.

MAKE IT YOURS

- **Work in the DOCX, not the PDF.** Change names, local details, and illustrations. Put your own stories in your own voice.
- **Keep the evidence.** The co-regency of Belshazzar, the temple vessels, the handwriting, and the fall of Babylon to Cyrus in 539 BC are doing theological work.
- **Update the title page** if you change the title or primary text.
- **The deck is fully editable.** All text is live. Georgia sets the headings and Candara the body; if either is missing on your machine, swap both for fonts you have.
- **Read it aloud once before Sunday.** If a sentence trips you, change it.

GUARDRAILS

- Do not cartoon Belshazzar. He is a warned man who knew the family record and refused to humble himself.
- Keep the history honest: Belshazzar was a co-regent, "father" is dynastic language, and Darius the Mede's identity is debated.
- The temple vessels were holy because God claimed them, not because gold has magic.
- Do not use Daniel's refusal of gifts to attack all payment for ministry; the point is the price, not the salary.
- Do not equate the Lord's Supper with Belshazzar's feast. Protect the hand, the refusal, the verdict, and the cross.

TAKE IT TO THE PULPIT

MIN	SECTION
5	Introduction: The night the music stopped
7	The feast and the vessels
8	The hand and the fear
8	The queen, the prophet, and the refusal
8	MENE MENE TEKEL PARSIN
6	The night the kingdom fell
7	Application: What do you do with the weight?
3	The invitation
5	Response and closing

57 minutes with the full response; 55–60 with normal variation. The manuscript is 6,840 words at about 120 words per minute.

If you have 50 minutes: Introduction to 4, Movement 1 to 6, Movement 2 to 6, Movement 4 to 7, Application to 6. Keep the vessels, the hand, "weighed and found wanting," and the gospel turn. Never cut the hand writing, Daniel's refusal, or the cross.

THE LICENSE AT A GLANCE

One license covers one congregation or campus, any preacher on staff. It does not expire.

YOU MAY

- Preach and teach this sermon in one congregation or campus, as often as you like.
- Edit the manuscript for local context and your own voice.
- Record and stream it as part of normal services.
- Print the outline and guide for your preaching team and groups.
- Keep the files on a private, access-controlled system.

YOU MAY NOT

- Share the files with preachers outside your congregation.
- Post the manuscript publicly or sell it.
- Republish it as a standalone work, edited or not.
- Use one license across multiple campuses.
- Use the material at a paid conference or event without written permission.

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TELL ME HOW IT WENT

Reply to the email that delivered this kit. Three questions, short answers:

1. Do you preach — pastor, lay preacher, teacher, or something else?
2. Which of the nine forgotten figures should I write next?
3. Where did you hear about this kit?

Tell me your preaching date and what you changed. I read every reply; it decides which kit comes next.

If this kit does not save you a full day of sermon prep, reply within 14 days for a refund.